

Price watch

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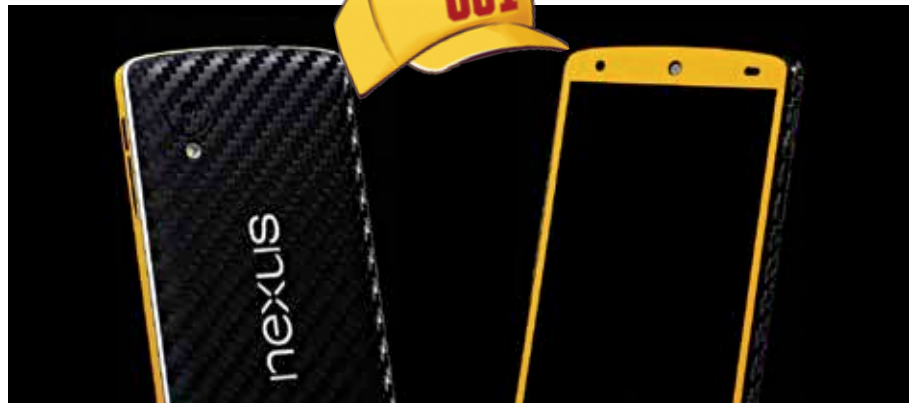
Beautify your phone

Agent 001 goes hunting for smartphone customisation options.

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Well, smartphones are something no one can live without in the current day and age and it's a known fact that we spend more time tapping away endlessly on our screens than is necessary at times. Since we devote so much time to our smart devices, it's quite easy to get bored with their look and feel after having used them for long. This is one of the scenarios where customisation comes into the picture. I was pondering over this very thought looking at my trusty Nexus 4 (Yes, I still have one apart from my daily driver) inside a rickshaw that was meandering pot-holed roads in Mumbai monsoons to a place where I was supposed to meet an old friend. This Nexus 4 wasn't protected by a case, skin or wrap of any kind and this was the case ever since I had purchased it over two years ago. But lately, I've been thinking that I should do something about it. Not because I have important data but for the very fact that it's starting to appear quite stale.

The rickshaw came to an abrupt halt as I had arrived at my destination and I entered the restaurant to find my friend sitting there enjoying what he had ordered. On seeing me, he got up to greet me and midway, as the clumsy person he is known to be since our college days, he drops his phone straight onto the restaurant's hard flooring. His jaw probably hit the floor before his phone but he recovered quickly and picked it up to see if it was alright. Unfortunately for him, his Moto X got a bad dent on one of its corners but he was darn lucky that the screen was unharmed. After all, the MOTO X's screen



is quite expensive to replace. He looked at me, sighed in relief and said "I should definitely get a case of some sort because I keep dropping my phone". To which I said: "Yes, you definitely need to, I wonder how that phone has survived this long. But you know what? Since your birthday is coming up next month, let me gift you a nice case. What say?". He looked sheepishly at me, nodded and said "Alright! But don't get me one of those blingy fake diamond studded ones okay?".

Later that night, I came back home and started looking at ways to customise the appearance. I must say that there were far too many different options available in that regard but from what I saw, most of them offered a flimsy plastic case to protect the back of your phone and in most cases there was some design or image on the back. I prefer not to go for thick cases since they add too much bulk to the phone than I'm comfortable with. I tried searching for other ways that can add more flair to my phone and stumbled on a beautifully made website called dbrand.com. As it turns out, the guys at dbrand are known the world over for manufacturing the most precisely fitting skins for smartphones and other devices. Looking at the different skins they had for sale, I was sold in minutes. They offer skins of different colours with textures like carbon fibre, matte, metal, leather, true colour and wood as well. These skins are merely good quality 3M backed stickers

with textures that feel like the real material on them for your devices, and they offer a great way to customise your device without adding bulk. Although dbrand is a Canadian company, they ship worldwide for a nominal fee and it takes around two weeks for their products to be shipped to India. I selected the Black carbon fibre skin for my Nexus 4 with the Nexus cutout at the back since it looked classy and professional. While I was still on their website, I saw skins for the PS4 and impulsively bought one for my console as well.

Now, I had to search for a heavy duty case for my friend's Moto X 2nd Gen. This is why, all those regular plastic cases were out of the picture. I remember seeing a few phone covers online that were made of two materials and merged into one for added protection. A quick search showed that heavy duty cases by Otterbox and Amzer were really good for protecting your phone. Otterbox offered a hybrid option from their Defender series which was really well made but was expensive and shipping here was on the costlier side. This is why, I selected the Amzer Hybrid Kickstand case for my friend's Motorola Moto X (2nd Gen) and I got it for ₹800 from Amzer's Indian web page. This hybrid case offered a lot of protection for the phone and was built like a tank which was exactly what my friend needed.

Since Raksha Bandhan was right around the corner, I contemplated buying